

July

17

1955

Disneyland opens

Built under the supervision of Walt Disney, the Disneyland theme park in California, USA, opened for the first time. The park now welcomes millions of visitors every year.



Also on this day

709 BCE The first confirmed total solar eclipse to be recorded in history was seen by Chinese astronomers, according to the ancient text *Lüshi Chunqiu*.

1936 An uprising by nationalist rebels opposed to Spain's left-wing government triggered the start of the Spanish Civil War, which would last until 1939.

Born this day

1954 Angela Merkel, German politician. She became Germany's first female chancellor (head of government) in 2005 and was re-elected in 2009, 2013, and 2018.

1717

Floating orchestra

The *Water Music* by German-born composer George Frideric Handel was performed for the first time at a concert that took place on a barge on the River

Thames in Britain. King George I, who watched from another boat, asked for the music to be replayed multiple times.

